suffer on account of India's failure to conclude the Teesta river agreement. India's response to the spill-over into Bangladesh of the Rohingya crisis in Myanmar has also not gone well with Bangladesh despite its humanitarian assistance in meeting the pressure of nearly a million refugees.[15] India is seen in Bangladesh as a strong supporter of Hasina Wajid's Awami League government. This is resented by the main opposition Bangladesh Nationalist Party (BNP) of Khalida Zia. The 2019 general election has returned the Awami League government headed by Hasina Wajid to power.

Constraints and challenges

Dents in the neighbourhood policy have been inflicted by a variety of factors. To begin with, the muscular component of the policy has not gone well with the neighbours. Recall the Foreign Secretary's assertion that the policy will be "reasonable and firm" where needed and India will be pursuing its "own goals purposefully." This amounted to a policy of assertive unilateralism. It was this firmness that led to the breakdown of engagement with Pakistan and accounted for the much debated "surgical strikes" in September 2016. Similar operations had been undertaken against Indian insurgents within Myanmar in June 2015. The message sent by such actions to other neighbours was to be cautious and restrained in their dealings with India. Coercive economic diplomacy of Nepal on the issue of the Constitution was also a part of this muscular policy, which has caused more harm than good.

The credibility of India's muscular stance suffers from the inherent weakness of its basic policy on account of delivery deficit. India falls short on delivering on its promises, both in